



Metropolitan Plan Commission, February 5th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wSFQSzdZCzQ
Publication Date	2026-02-06T11:29:39Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Report: Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Planning Commission

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Chris Smith called the regular February meeting of the Muncie-Delaware Metropolitan Planning Commission to order **00:00:06**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Steven Brand **00:00:42**, Nate Carol **00:00:44**, Owen Lache **00:00:57**, Chris Smith **00:01:07**, and Richard Ivy (arrived during proceedings at **00:06:36**).
 - **Members Absent:** Tom Borchers, Jerry Dishman, Teresa Hensley, Emily Cring, Jesse Landis, Adam Leach, and Ricky Cyp. (Note: Roll call recorded multiple names without immediate spoken responses, but a later quorum was confirmed).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Chris Smith (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board **00:00:10**.

- **Approval of Minutes:** The prior meeting minutes from January were presented, motioned, and approved by a roll call vote of 5 yeses and 2 abstentions (Owen Lache abstained due to absence) 00:01:16, 00:02:14.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:19 Item Identifier & Title:** MPC03-26A – Petition to Vacate Lots, Alleys, and Streets within the Original Plat of the Town of Mount Pleasant (Lots 1-2 in Block 6; Lots 3-8 in Block 6; portions of Lots 1, 2, 6, 7 in Block 7; Lots 3-4, 5, 8 and portions of Lots 2, 6, 7 in Block 7; Lots 1, 2, 5, 6 in Block 8; and Lots 1-4 in Block 5).
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Vanice, Ashton Land Surveyor (representing property owners).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The presenter explained that the 1837 plat was never improved or brought up to modern standards. Certain structures (including a barn) currently sit in the middle of unmapped or unimproved streets, and existing parcels are undersized. Vacating this specific section of the plat allows owners to legally combine parcels into better-utilized configurations. Under Indiana Code 36-7-3-12, because the entire section of the plat is being vacated rather than just adjacent rights-of-way, jurisdiction falls to the Plan Commission rather than the County Commissioners.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by unanimous roll call vote (8 yeses, 0 nos) 00:10:53, 00:11:28.
- **00:11:43 Item Identifier & Title:** MPC01-26Z – Zone Change Appeal by Hunter Family Irrevocable Grantor Trust and Honey Rock Farms (6915 East County Road 550 South, Muncie, IN). Request to change zoning from split R-3 Residence Zone / F Farming Zone to F Farming Zone for properties located at 12049 South County Road 349 East and 11721 South County Road 396 East.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Vanice, Ashton Land Surveyor.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Following the vacation of the old plat, these parcels require zoning unification. Parts of the land are split-zoned between R-3 and Farming, while being utilized strictly for farming. Additionally, removing an old structure in front of an existing barn would otherwise trigger non-compliance issues under the R-3 zone (accessory structure without a primary structure). Re-zoning to Farming resolves this and unifies the land into the farm operations.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Favorable recommendation approved by roll call vote (8 yeses, 0 nos). Forwarded to the County Commissioners for final action on February 16th 00:15:22, 00:15:53.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No general public comments were brought forward during this portion of the meeting.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Legislative Updates:** City Council adopted subdivision text amendments regarding natural features (MPC05-25A) and 2025 City zone map changes (MPC01-26A) on February 2nd. County Commissioners adopted unincorporated Delaware County zone map changes (MPC02-26A) on January 20th 00:16:42.
 - **Director's Report:**
 - 55 permits issued year-to-date totaling \$7,031.50 in fees; County Building Commissioner Tom Fouch completed 90 inspections through January.
 - MPO transportation calendar year 2025 reimbursements totaled \$516,955.30, with \$377,368.84 returned to County General. State Fiscal Year 2027 UPWP cost allocation plan has been approved by INDOT and Federal Highway.
 - **Plat Committee Re-approval:** The commission conducted a formal motion and voice vote to approve the full roster of Plat Committee voting and advisory members (Voting: John Anderson, Tom Borchers, Adam Leach, Courtney Puit, Ricky Cyp; Advisory: Dean Thomas, Heather Beard, Paula Morrison, Jan Smoot, Emily Reese, Diana Terazzi). Approved by Voice Vote 00:23:09.
 - **Staffing:** Kayla Ferguson hired as the new Demographics, Zoning Appeals Planner, and GIS Specialist (replacing Fred Daniel) 00:23:46.
 - **Board Presentation:** Board President Chris Smith announced his upcoming historical presentation, *"In the Footsteps of Lewis and Clark,"* scheduled for Friday, March 20th, from 6:00 to 7:30 p.m. 00:23:59.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned following board announcements 00:26:32.

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